CITY UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
Chan Feng Men-ling Chan Shuk-lin Language Centre

EAP 1 | LC0200A

English for Academic Purposes 1

Coursework Essay
(30%)

Assessment Pack

This pack has 6 pages including this page.

Semester:	Semester A, 2026-27
When:	Weeks 4-12, In-course
Deadline of final submission:	7:59 a.m., 16 November 2026 (Monday)

Context:
You are writing an argumentative essay for academic readers who have an interest in the following subject but may not have special knowledge in the field.

Essay topic:

The growing popularity of electric vehicles has sparked a debate about their role in addressing transportation-related environmental challenges. While electric vehicles offer significant benefits such as lower greenhouse gas emissions and improved air quality, concerns about battery production and electricity sources raise questions about their overall sustainability.

Read the sources provided in this assessment pack, conduct your own research, and argue for your opinion about whether electric vehicles should be promoted as a sustainable solution to reduce transportation-related environmental impacts.

Length: 750-1000 words

Writing skills to be assessed:
- Task Fulfilment (25%)
- Discourse Competencies (25%)
- Language Competencies (35%)
- Source Integration (15%)

For details about these four criteria, please refer to the full marking scheme available in your Canvas course site.

Requirements for the source articles to be included in your essay:

You should read widely around the issue and become familiar with different standpoints in order to form your own informed opinion. You must support your opinion thoroughly, using appropriate sources.

- **Sources from this assessment pack:** Three sources are provided in this assessment pack (page 4). You MUST cite from at least one of these sources, but you may cite from all of them.

- **Your own sources:** You MUST cite from one outside source that you find from your own research, but you may cite from up to THREE sources from your own research. These sources should be academic, or of an appropriate level of formality and reliability. Your course teacher can advise on this. These sources must have been written and published in English.

- In other words, in your essay you must include between a **minimum of two sources** and a **maximum of six. If you do not follow this instruction, your essay will be penalized** (see the marking scheme available in your Canvas course site).

- The table below illustrates minimum and maximum numbers of sources for your reference:

	Source(s) from this assessment pack	**Your own source(s)**	**Total number of sources cited in your essay**
MINIMUM number of sources	1	1	**2**
MAXIMUM number of sources	3	3	**6**

Requirements for the content of your essay:

In addition to using the ideas derived from other researchers, you MUST use your own ideas to write the essay.

You should clearly express your opinion and support your argument with in-depth elaboration.

The register of your essay:

Your essay must be written in academic English and follow the APA 7th referencing style.

More about the writing of your essay:

- Your essay must include an introduction, body paragraphs showing your main points, a conclusion, and a reference list following the APA style.

- Your essay must be typed, double-spaced, and with a font size of 12. Margins must be 2.5 cm.

- When ANY idea or piece of information does not come from you, you MUST acknowledge the source.

- Direct quotations can be no more than 10% of your essay length.

- Direct quotations must not be longer than 30 words.

- Remember that in academic writing, paraphrase and summary are more commonly used than direct quotation.

- Your essay must be completely your own work, written specifically for this assignment.

The Submission of your Essay:

- Mid-way through this assessment period, you must submit the first draft of your essay to your class teacher. This draft will not be assessed. However, it must be a complete essay of at least 450 words, adhering to the template provided by your teacher. **The submission date for your first draft is 7:59 a.m., on Monday 19th October. If you do not submit a first draft, you will not be allowed to submit a final draft on 16th November.**

- **Late submissions of the first draft** will be accepted for up to 3 days following the submission deadline, but if you submit late, you may not receive feedback from your teacher.

- **Late submissions of the final draft** will be accepted for up to three days after the final submission deadline (see page 1) but will receive a marks penalty of 10% of the total assessment score for each day they are late (e.g. an essay submitted two days late will receive a penalty of 20% of the total assessment score). After three days, no essay submissions will be accepted. Earlier drafts will not be graded. Students with no essay submission will score '0' for this assessment.

- Both essay submissions (the first for teacher feedback, the second for final grading) must be done on Canvas through Turnitin, a plagiarism detection program, preferably one or two days ahead of the submission deadline to ensure that your Turnitin similarity report can be generated in good time.

Work Portfolio:

You are required to maintain and submit a work portfolio of your research and essay writing. This work portfolio should include the following:

i> Copies of all source texts you used
ii> All your writing drafts
iii> A truthful and complete record of your use of AI tools (if any), including:
- The specific tool(s) used
- The prompted submitted
- The responses generated
- Your own work without AI assistance

This requirement serves three key purposes:

i> It documents your work progress and showcases how you integrate any use of GenAI into your writing process, which helps to enhance your understanding of and critical engagement with both your topic and the technology.
ii> Your portfolio serves as valuable documentation of your writing process and responsible use of GenAI, providing clear insights into your approach and decision-making. This can be beneficial if questions arise, as it allows you to confidently demonstrate your work process and AI use experiences.
iii> This record of work is an important step in preparing for your Final Speaking and IL examination, where you may be asked about the authorship of your essay.

It is important to note that any intentional concealment of information from your portfolio, such as failing to disclose the use of AI tools or misrepresenting your contributions, will be considered academic dishonesty and may result in disciplinary actions.

Use of Generative AI Tools:

The use of GenAI tools is generally permitted in this assignment. However, you should use them responsibly and transparently. The goal is for AI to enhance your skills and capabilities, but not to replace them. Therefore, while you can use GenAI to assist you in writing your essay, it is important to focus on using it as a supportive tool rather than generating content entirely.

When using AI as an assistant, remember to develop a verification process to check the information you receive. You must include a declaration with your assignment submission detailing how these tools were utilised. You must also keep a record of your GenAI use, including the specific tool(s) used, the prompts

submitted, responses generated, and your own work without AI assistance. This record will be submitted as part of your final submission.

In this assignment, AI tools can be effectively used for the following ways/tasks:

- Conducting secondary research, e.g. finding relevant academic sources, understanding studies and articles.
- Brainstorming ideas
- Suggesting paraphrases and/or translations of texts
- Polishing the drafts by providing grammar checks, style suggestions, and plagiarism detection
- Formatting the report to meet the APA style guides

However, certain uses of AI are less appropriate for this assignment:

- **Completing your Essay Outline**

  This task is crucial for structuring your essay, as it helps you organise your own thoughts. Relying on AI to plan and complete your outline may prevent you from fully grasping the flow of your essay and how each body paragraph relates to your overall argument. Additionally, it may hinder your ability to critically engage with your research and develop the analytical skills that are vital for your learning process.

- **Drafting/writing/generating content and presenting it as your own work**

  Submitting AI-generated content as your own undermines the authenticity of your research and your ability to communicate your unique contributions. Using AI in this way also raises plagiarism concerns, as AI does not create original content but rather compiles and rephrases information from various sources without proper acknowledgement.

- **Using GenAI as a source in itself**

  Relying on AI-generated information without cross-referencing it with credible literature can lead to inaccuracies or even false information, as AI may fabricate citations or details about studies that do not exist. This can mislead your research and undermine its credibility. Therefore, it is crucial to use diverse, credible sources to support your arguments and ensure an accurate understanding of your topic. This means that you should always check any sources AI may suggest for their authenticity and cite the original source.

- **Writing your drafts in your mother language and using AI to translate the whole text**

  While translation can be useful, relying solely on AI for this purpose may result in a loss of nuance and meaning. You should draft your work in English and interact with AI in English as well, as this practice can enhance your language skills and help you articulate your thoughts more effectively in the target language.

An Important Reminder about Academic Honesty:

Although this coursework essay is a process writing assessment and you are working outside of class, there are certain guidelines you must follow:

- Do not ask friends / siblings / others to proofread your work. You will be given feedback from your class teacher. This should be enough for you to make significant changes to your first and final drafts. If you feel that you would like more feedback, you can make an appointment to see an advisor in the Writing Studio.
- Do not copy from other EAP students.
- Do not copy from the Internet or other sources without following APA citation conventions.
- Do not copy from essays you have written in the past.
- Do not copy from model essays, including any that you may have found online or received from secondary school, tutorial centres, or as part of this course.

If your teacher feels that your essay is not a representative sample of your own work or believes it to include any material from other sources which have not been appropriately cited, they will have to report it to the Course Coordinator for a possible formal investigation into plagiarism or other academic misconduct. It is essential that you follow the university's guidelines on academic honesty to ensure that this does not happen.

This process writing assessment provides you with a chance to achieve your best performance by going through a drafting and rewriting process. Such a process involves both teacher input and your personal revisions as you notice errors and learn more from your EAP classes and LCSS services. It also allows you to find new ways to make your writing more sophisticated.

Sources

(Please refer to page 2 for instructions about the number of source articles to be used in your essay. Please note that the following information does NOT follow APA formatting conventions.)

Source 1

Article title: Impact of Electric Vehicles on the Environment: Pros and Cons

Author: Larisa Kapustina, Natalia Izakova

Publication: E3S Web of Conferences, Volume 451, 2023

Retrieved from: Impact of Electric Vehicles on the Environment: Pros and Cons

DOI: https://doi.org/10.1051/e3sconf/202345102003

Source 2

Article title: Electric Vehicles: Solution or New Problem?

Author: Amela Ajanovic, Reinhard Haas

Publication: Environment, Development and Sustainability, Volume 20 (Suppl 1), 2018, Pages 7-22

Retrieved from: Electric vehicles: solution or new problem? | Environment, Development and Sustainability

DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/s10668-018-0190-3

Source 3

Article title: Impact of Electric Vehicle Development on China's Energy Consumption and Greenhouse Gas Emissions

Authors: Xue Yan, Shouheng Sun

Publication: Clean Technologies and Environmental Policy, Volume 23, Issue number 10, 2021, Pages 2909-2925

Retrieved from: Impact of electric vehicle development on China's energy consumption and greenhouse gas emissions | Clean Technologies and Environmental Policy

DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/s10098-021-02209-6